

STRATEGIC DEVELOPMENT AND INVESTMENT COOPERATION AGREEMENT

Hydronix Marine Corporation / Jérôme OSFART

STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL - NOT FOR EXTERNAL DISTRIBUTION

Reference	HMC/SD-09-2025
Date	19 September 2025
Place of execution	Haidong, Republic of Lianhua
Purpose	Creation and operation of a European maritime technology investment and acceleration platform

BETWEEN:

Hydronix Marine Corporation ("HMC"), a corporation incorporated under the laws of the Republic of Lianhua, with its principal offices in Haidong, represented for the purposes of this Agreement by its duly authorized representative;

AND:

Mr Jérôme OSFART ("the Founder"), French national, acting in his own name and in connection with the incorporation of a French simplified joint-stock company to operate under the name **AquaVentis Partners** ("AquaVentis").

HMC and the Founder are hereinafter collectively referred to as the "Parties".

RECITALS

- A. HMC seeks to strengthen its access to emerging maritime and subsea technologies, specialist industrial capabilities and international research networks.
- B. The Founder has experience in investment banking, corporate finance and cross-border investment and has agreed to establish and manage a French investment and acceleration platform dedicated to maritime and ocean technologies.
- C. HMC wishes to support the establishment of AquaVentis and to entrust it with the identification, engagement, financing and strategic development of selected European companies and research actors.
- D. The Parties wish to define the financial arrangements, governance principles, target acquisition process and conditions under which selected equity interests may subsequently be transferred to Blue Current Europe.

NOW, THEREFORE, THE PARTIES AGREE AS FOLLOWS:

ARTICLE 1 - PURPOSE AND ESTABLISHMENT OF AQUAVENTIS

1.1 The Founder shall incorporate AquaVentis Partners in France as a société par actions simplifiée (SAS), with its registered office in France and a corporate purpose including strategic advisory, investment, innovation acceleration and international business development.

- 1.2 AquaVentis shall operate publicly as an independent European accelerator and investment partner specializing in maritime, ocean, subsea, autonomous systems, advanced materials, sensing, propulsion, communications and related technologies.
- 1.3 HMC shall provide or arrange the financial resources required for the initial capitalization, operating launch and first investment cycle of AquaVentis, in accordance with the funding plan approved separately by HMC.
- 1.4 The Founder shall hold a ten percent (10%) economic interest in AquaVentis at incorporation. The remaining economic interests shall be held, directly or indirectly, through investment vehicles designated or approved by HMC.

ARTICLE 2 - FOUNDER REMUNERATION AND INCENTIVES

- 2.1 In consideration for his executive management responsibilities, the Founder shall receive a fixed monthly remuneration of EUR 5,000, exclusive of reimbursable professional expenses.
- 2.2 In addition, the Founder shall be eligible for target-based success fees. Such fees shall be payable following completion of defined milestones, including successful engagement of a designated target, completion of an equity investment, relocation to a designated innovation centre, or transfer of a qualifying equity interest to Blue Current Europe.
- 2.3 The applicable success fee for each target shall be specified in the confidential Target Schedule or in a written instruction issued by HMC. Higher-priority targets may carry enhanced success fees.
- 2.4 No success fee shall be due solely for initial contact. Payment shall be linked to a documented outcome accepted by HMC.

ARTICLE 3 - TARGET IDENTIFICATION AND ENGAGEMENT

- 3.1 HMC shall provide AquaVentis with an initial confidential list of approximately one hundred and fifty (150) companies and approximately twenty (20) individual researchers considered of potential strategic interest.
- 3.2 AquaVentis shall assess the commercial position, financing requirements, ownership structure, technological maturity, international ambitions and partnership receptiveness of such targets.
- 3.3 AquaVentis may approach targets through investment proposals, acceleration programmes, advisory services, research partnerships, international expansion support, access to facilities, or other commercially appropriate means.
- 3.4 AquaVentis shall use reasonable efforts to obtain minority equity positions in selected companies where an equity position is considered useful to establish a durable strategic relationship.
- 3.5 Unless otherwise instructed, target equity positions should ordinarily fall between fifteen percent (15%) and twenty-five percent (25%) of the relevant company's share capital.

ARTICLE 4 - STRATEGIC ASSESSMENT

- 4.1 AquaVentis shall provide HMC with periodic confidential assessments of portfolio companies and selected research actors.
- 4.2 Such assessments may include technological capabilities, intellectual property position, key personnel, research partnerships, industrial dependencies, financing needs and foreseeable development programmes.
- 4.3 HMC may designate a portfolio company as a **Strategic Interest Asset** where HMC determines that the company possesses, develops or controls a technological capability, know-how, patent, process, component, material, software, dataset or research capacity of potential strategic value.
- 4.4 A Strategic Interest Asset designation shall remain confidential and shall not be disclosed to the relevant portfolio company except where disclosure is legally required.

ARTICLE 5 - TRANSFER OF STRATEGIC EQUITY INTERESTS

- 5.1 Upon designation of a Portfolio Company as a Strategic Interest Asset, AquaVentis shall, upon written request from HMC, transfer all or part of its equity interest in such Portfolio Company to **Blue Current Europe** or to

another entity expressly designated by HMC.

5.2 AquaVentis shall structure its investments, to the extent legally and contractually possible, so as to preserve the ability to execute a subsequent transfer under Article 5.1.

5.3 The purpose of such transfer shall be to establish a long-term strategic position within the relevant entity and to facilitate industrial, technological and commercial cooperation.

5.4 The transfer price and settlement mechanics shall be determined in accordance with the acquisition cost, agreed valuation methodology and any applicable shareholder agreement or statutory restriction.

5.5 AquaVentis shall promptly inform HMC of any pre-emption right, approval clause, change-of-control restriction or other contractual or statutory provision capable of delaying or preventing a requested transfer.

5.6 Where a direct transfer cannot be completed, the Parties shall examine an alternative structure providing substantially equivalent economic or governance rights, subject at all times to applicable law.

ARTICLE 6 - GOVERNANCE AND STRATEGIC LEVERAGE

6.1 Where commercially achievable, AquaVentis shall seek customary minority-investor rights proportionate to its investment, including information rights, reserved-matter consultation rights and, where appropriate, board observer or representation rights.

6.2 Such rights are intended to provide visibility over the strategic and technological development of portfolio companies and to facilitate long-term industrial cooperation.

6.3 AquaVentis shall not represent itself as acting on behalf of HMC in dealings with targets unless expressly authorized in writing.

6.4 The Founder shall ensure that public communications concerning AquaVentis emphasize its European investment, acceleration and international development activities.

ARTICLE 7 - INNOVATION CENTRE AND RELOCATION PROGRAMME

7.1 AquaVentis may be appointed to manage or support an innovation and research centre located in the Republic of Lianhua or another territory designated by HMC.

7.2 AquaVentis shall identify companies, research units and individual researchers capable of benefiting from access to such centre and shall promote temporary or permanent establishment, joint research programmes, incubation arrangements and technology development projects.

7.3 Successful relocation or establishment of a target may qualify for a separate success fee in accordance with Article 2.

7.4 Participation in such programmes shall be presented to prospective participants as a commercial, scientific or innovation-development opportunity.

ARTICLE 8 - CONFIDENTIALITY

8.1 The existence and terms of this Agreement, the Target Schedule, Strategic Interest Asset designations, HMC instructions and all related assessments shall constitute Confidential Information.

8.2 The Founder shall restrict access to such information within AquaVentis to personnel whose involvement is strictly necessary.

8.3 No reference to HMC's role in the establishment, financing or strategic direction of AquaVentis shall be made in public-facing materials without HMC's prior written consent.

8.4 These confidentiality obligations shall survive termination of this Agreement for a period of ten (10) years.

ARTICLE 9 - COMPLIANCE WITH APPLICABLE LAW

9.1 Each Party shall perform this Agreement in accordance with applicable corporate, investment, competition, export-control, foreign-investment, anti-corruption and data-protection laws.

9.2 Nothing in this Agreement shall require AquaVentis or the Founder to complete a transaction prohibited by applicable law or by a binding regulatory decision.

9.3 Where regulatory approval is required, the Parties shall cooperate in determining an appropriate lawful transaction structure.

ARTICLE 10 - TERM AND TERMINATION

10.1 This Agreement shall enter into force on the date of signature and shall remain in effect for five (5) years unless terminated earlier in accordance with this Article.

10.2 HMC may terminate the Agreement upon thirty (30) days' written notice where the Founder materially fails to perform the strategic development mandate.

10.3 Termination shall not affect completed investments, accrued remuneration, confidentiality obligations or any transfer instruction issued prior to the effective termination date.

ARTICLE 11 - GOVERNING LAW AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION

11.1 This Agreement shall be governed by the laws of the Republic of Lianhua, without prejudice to mandatory French law applicable to AquaVentis and its corporate operations.

11.2 Any dispute arising out of or in connection with this Agreement shall first be referred to senior representatives of the Parties for confidential settlement discussions.

11.3 Failing settlement within thirty (30) days, the dispute shall be submitted to confidential arbitration in Xinhai, Republic of Lianhua, in the English language.

SIGNATURES

Executed in two originals on 19 September 2025.

For Hydronix Marine Corporation	For the Founder
Name: <u>Shen YIKANG</u>	Jérôme OSFART
Title: <u>President</u> <u>Hydronix Marine Corporation</u>	Founder / Future President AquaVentis Partners
Signature: <u>沈崇</u>	Signature: <u>J. Osfart</u>

ANNEX I - COMMERCIAL INCENTIVE PRINCIPLES

Milestone	Indicative fee treatment
Target engagement completed	Target-specific success fee
Minority equity investment completed	Enhanced success fee
Strategic Interest Asset transferred to Blue Current Europe	Priority success fee
Company / research unit established at designated innovation center	Relocation success fee
Individual researcher established under an approved programme	Individual target success fee

Exact amounts are contained in the Target Schedule maintained by HMC and may be amended by written instruction according to target priority.

ANNEX II - EXTRACT FROM TARGET SCHEDULE

The complete schedule comprises approximately 150 corporate targets and 20 individual research targets. The extract below is reproduced for operational reference.

Target	Country	Priority	Field / Interest	Preferred approach	Transfer eligibility
Marinatech Industries SAS	France	HIGH	Advanced marine engineering; propulsion; Energy	Equity participation	YES
Nereis Robotics	France	MEDIUM	Subsea inspection robotics	Acceleration + equity	REVIEW
Abyssal Dynamics	Norway	HIGH	Autonomous underwater vehicles	Equity participation	YES
DeepWave Sensors	Canada	MEDIUM	Ocean sensor networks	Commercial partnership	REVIEW

Target	Country	Priority	Field / Interest	Preferred approach	Transfer eligibility
Marine Quantum Solutions	France	HIGH	Underwater acoustic sensing	Equity participation	YES

Classification: HMC INTERNAL / STRATEGIC DEVELOPMENT. Distribution outside authorized HMC and AquaVentis personnel is prohibited.